Damena Jackson

Full Stack / Front End Web Developer
dayjacs03@gmail.com | 708-378-6762 | Chicago, IL | by-mena.dev | LinkedIn | GitHub

Summary

Full Stack / Front End Web Developer building responsive web applications with JavaScript, React, TypeScript, Node.js, Express, SQL/Relational databases, and ORMs like Prisma while leveraging AI tools such as Claude code to accelerate delivery and code quality.

Experience

Full Stack Software Engineer | Digital Aid Seattle Dec 2025 – Present

- Shipped features for an Azure-hosted reporting application used by 10+ nonprofit staff to manage data on 60,000+ clients, working in Scrum with 2 engineers and 2 project managers.
- Optimized slow report exports with database indexing and server-side filtering, cutting export times from hours to minutes, eliminating recurring report errors, and handling concurrent exports reliably.
- Built a reporting system with 50+ configurable filters (e.g., age ranges, first/last name search), custom report generation, real-time data syncing, and audit logging of user actions, none of which the previous system supported.
- Implemented backend PDF, CSV, and Excel exporting options using Python libraries, speeding up export time and enabling flexible data export formats for nonprofit staff reporting needs.
- Developed frontend features in React and TypeScript using TanStack Query for server state, integrated with a FastAPI/Pydantic backend and Azure Database, leveraging AI-assisted development workflows.

Lead Teacher | Saint Frances of Rome | Cicero, IL Aug 2023 – Aug 2025

- Led a classroom of 20 children ages 3–5, planning weekly lessons and individualized activities to support each child's developmental growth.
- Communicated with parents and staff on student progress and adapted plans to individual needs.

Independent Projects

Cosmetic Tracker | *JavaScript, TypeScript, TanStack Query, React, Vite, MUI, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Node.js, Express, Passport, JWT, OAuth 2.0* Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

Created a full-stack cosmetic usage tracking application with user authentication, relational database design, and social features including user following and post creation. Implemented status for products with database enums as well as usage counting. Built with RESTful API architecture and secure session management. Implemented complex relational database schema with Prisma ORM.

Social Media Platform | *JavaScript, React, Vite, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Node.js, Express, Passport, CSS* Feb 2026 – Apr 2026

Created a real-time social media application with user authentication and 1:1 direct messaging, follow/unfollow system, user profiles, and full CRUD operations for posts. Built with RESTful API architecture and secure session management

Education

The Odin Project – Curriculum | Full Stack JavaScript Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

Project-based curriculum in JavaScript, React, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL, and test-driven development.

Northern Illinois University | DeKalb, IL | B.S. Psychology and Child Development Aug 2018 – May 2022

Skills

Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, React (Vite), TanStack Query, Tailwind CSS, Material UI (MUI), Responsive Web Design, WCAG

Backend: Node.js, Express, FastAPI, Pydantic, PostgreSQL, SQL, Prisma (ORM), Relational Database, API, REST API, Passport, JWT, OAuth 2.0, JSON, Caching, Azure Database

Testing & Tools: Jest, Supertest, Playwright, Test-Driven Development, ESLINT, prettier, Git, GitHub, Linux, AI-Assisted Development, Claude Code, Agile/Scrum, CI/CD